Claude for ESOL Prep – 70-Minute Session Plan (Trainer)

Audience: ESOL teachers, free Claude accounts. **Aim:** each teacher leaves with a set-up project and one thing made for their class.

Bring: the project instructions doc, a sample of learner writing, a projector.

Timings

Time	Activity	Who
0–5	What Claude is, how I use it, free limits	Me
5–17	Set up a project with the instructions	Everyone
17–27	Demo 1: E1 speaking practice dialogue	Me, then they try
27–37	Demo 2: E3 reading text and exam questions	Me, then they try
37–45	Demo 3: marking a writing script	Me
45–55	Make one thing for their class	Everyone
55–65	Show and tell: tools, lessons and games I've built (2 slides)	Me
65–70	Saving usage, Q&A	Everyone

0–5: Intro (informal)

- How I use it: writing, checking and adapting materials. I'm still learning and make plenty of mistakes. Take what's useful.
- Free accounts have a usage limit that resets every few hours. Long chats and long outputs use it up fastest.

Teaser (30 seconds): mention you'll show some of your own lessons and games at the end.

5–17: Set up a project

- Create a project called "ESOL Prep".
- Paste in the project instructions. Change the level line to their class.
- Point out: Claude now knows the level, British English and worksheet rules every time, so prompts can be short.

17–27: Demo 1 – E1 speaking practice

Prompt:

> E1 speaking practice for the ESB exam. Topic: home and family. A short dialogue where each answer leads to only one next question. Then a gap-fill version learners can complete about their own life.

- Show it works for learners living alone or with family.
- Follow-up to show editing without a rewrite: *Make it shorter. Change nothing else.*
- Teachers try the same prompt with their own topic.

27–37: Demo 2 – E3 reading exam

Prompt:

> E3 reading text, about 250 words, set in Hackney. Topic: using the library. Then 6 questions in ESB style: multiple choice, true/false, short answer. Answer key at the end.

Then the key check:

> Check your questions. Do any use the same words as the text? If so, paraphrase them.

- Handy trick: asking Claude to check its own work catches a lot.

37–45: Demo 3 – marking writing

Paste in a piece of learner writing.

> This is an ESB [level] writing task. Would this learner pass today? Give 3 strengths, 3 things to work on, in simple words I can share.

- Handy for a quick second opinion.

45–55: Hands-on

Each teacher makes one thing for their class after half term: a worksheet, a dialogue, or a reading text. Pair up if stuck.

55–65: Show and tell – what's possible

Tools I built with Claude, hosted free online:

- Reading and writing level checks for placement
- Speaking placement interview guide
- ICT skills test, results going into Excel via Microsoft Forms
- StudentBio page collecting learners' stories

Message: these took longer conversations, so they're easier on a paid plan. But teachers can start small.

65–70: Saving usage and Q&A

- One task per chat. Start a new chat for a new task.
- Say level, topic and length in the first message.
- Ask for small changes, not a full rewrite.
- Copy finished work into Word straight away.
- Keep pasted text short.